STATE OF WASHINGTON
DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL AND HEALTH SERVICES
Community Services Division
Economic Services Administration
Post Office Box 45440 Olympia WA 98504-5440

May 17, 2024

Dear interested parties and community partners,

I am pleased to share changes that affect families engaged in the Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) and State Family Assistance (SFA) programs.

As of July 1, 2024, per passage of Substitute House Bill 2007, families who are over their 60 months of TANF cash assistance may qualify for an additional time limit extension. The infant, toddler or postpartum time limit extension is for parents with children in their home under the age of 2 who have exhausted their 60 months of TANF and continue to need aid. The parent must qualify for the infant, toddler or postpartum WorkFirst participation exemption to be eligible for this new time limit extension category.

This extension provides an opportunity for many families with young children to continue to access critical cash assistance benefits beyond 60 months.

Families who are not currently receiving TANF/SFA cash assistance can apply for benefits by:

- Calling the Customer Service Contact Center at 877-501-2233
- Applying online at WashingtonConnection.org
- Applying in person at their local CSO

If you have any questions about these changes, please do not hesitate to contact Melissa Kenney, TANF/WorkFirst Administrator, at Melissa.Kenney@dshs.wa.gov.

Sincerely,

Brice Montgomery, Interim Director
Community Services Division

DSHS: *Transforming Lives*